

Let's suppose you have a group of text files in an HDFS directory, *TextFiles*, and you want to store them as 'key, value' pairs in the HBase table—where the file name is the key and the file content is the value.

The following code illustrates a way of doing so. The code appears to be complex in order to avoid serialisation exceptions. (For an explanation, see <http://stackoverflow.com/questions/25250774/writing-to-hbase-via-spark-task-not-serializable>)

```
scala> val filesRDD = sc.wholeTextFiles("hdfs://
localhost/fedora/TextFiles")
scala> filesRDD.foreachPartition { iter =>
| val hbaseConf = HBaseConfiguration.create()
| val table = new HTable(hbaseConf, tableName)
| iter.foreach { x =>
|   var p = new Put(x._1.getBytes())
|   p.add("cf".getBytes(), "content".getBytes(), x._2.
getBytes())
|   table.put(p)
| }}
```

The parameter, *x*, is a (key, value) tuple, whose elements can be accessed as *x._1* and *x._2*, which is not a very

familiar syntax. The key is the file name, and the value is the contents of the file.

It is far more likely that you will want to use an existing HBase table. All you need to do is to create a Resilient Distributed Dataset (RDD) of the table; after that you can do all the operations available on an RDD, e.g., *count()* as shown below:

```
scala> val hBaseRDD = sc.newAPIHadoopRDD(conf,
classOf[TableInputFormat],
| classOf[org.apache.hadoop.hbase.
io.ImmutableBytesWritable],
| classOf[org.apache.hadoop.hbase.client.Result])
scala> hBaseRDD.count()
```

The Spark universe continues to expand as familiarity with it increases. It definitely seems like a technology with a bright future and worth exploring. 

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com> and <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, and reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.

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